

SUHA KIM

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FIELDS OF INTERESTS

Primary: Experimental Economics, Decision Theory
Secondary: Behavioral Economics

EDUCATION

The Ohio State University, Ph.D. in Economics	May 2027 (<i>Expected</i>)
Dissertation: “ <i>Learnings in the choice process</i> ”	Columbus, OH
Committee: Prof. John Rehbeck (Chair), Prof. Paul J Healy, Prof. Yaron Azrieli, Prof. Aldo Lucia	United States

The Ohio State University, M.A. in Economics	Aug 2022
	Columbus, OH
	United States

Sogang University, B.A. in Economics with Honors, B.S. in Mathematics	Feb 2019
Magna Cum Laude, Honors in Economic Theory	Seoul, South Korea

The Pennsylvania State University	Aug 2016 - Dec 2016
Undergraduate Exchange Student	State College, PA
Dean’s List	United States

RESEARCH

PUBLISHED WORKS

“Reciprocal preferences and expectations in International agreements”
with Doruk İriş, *Journal of Economic Behavior and Organization*, Oct 2025, Vol. 238: 107243

Abstract This paper investigates the impact of reciprocal preferences and countries’ fairness-based expectations of each other in the context of international agreements aimed at providing global public goods. Reciprocal countries reward kindness (positive reciprocity) while retaliating against unkind behavior (negative reciprocity). We introduce a model where countries decide not only whether to participate on a coalition but also determine the extent of their effort. We demonstrate that reciprocal preferences can exert both positive and negative effects on the effort of both signatories and non-signatories of a treaty, depending on their expectations of others. In the non-cooperative game, there are three possible Nash equilibria, which depend on the degree of reciprocal concerns and expectations: no contribution, full contribution by all, and an interior solution. In the coalition formation game, if countries have limited yet sufficiently strong reciprocal concerns and low expectations, the grand coalition – where all countries sign the treaty (and exert efficient effort levels) – becomes stable. Interestingly, we find that signatories positively influence non-signatories’ efforts. Anticipating this response, signatories have an additional strategic incentive to increase their efforts, thereby enhancing the overall level of cooperation.

WORKING PAPERS

“Information Representations and Choices in Costly Information Acquisition”

with Hyeonggyun Ko, Jason Tayawa

(Job Market Paper)

Abstract Do people acquire the same information when asked in accuracy or sampling size terms? Rational inattention models often treat information choice as choosing an accuracy level, yet the same choice can also be represented as choosing a sampling size. Theory treats these representations as equivalent, so revealed information-cost structure should be stable across them. We design a laboratory environment to test whether it is. Subjects choose from the same feasible information set, either by accuracy level or by the corresponding sampling size. We vary priors, rewards, and representation of information and evaluate behavior using the two major classes of models—Prior-Invariant (PI) and Uniformly Posterior-Separable (UPS) costs. Furthermore, we let subjects select the information from their preferred representation. Both classes of models are empirically valid in either representation of information, with PI observed more often in the sampling representation and UPS in the accuracy representation. Behavior is consistent: 60% of subjects are best fit by the same model in either representation. Even when consistent, different representations can reduce overall information. Representation choice is also consistent: 75% of subjects choose a single representation more often, with a majority choosing the sampling-size representation, contrasting with the modeling approach of Rational Inattention. Theoretically equivalent representations need not be behaviorally equivalent. The results invite future study about transporting revealed information costs across elicitation environments.

WORKS IN PROGRESS

“Distinguishing different forms of complexity: Math and Correlation Neglect”

with John Rehbeck

Abstract The complexity of a decision problem arises from various factors. We define and distinguish the factors of complexity: “Computational complexity,” “Implementation complexity,” and “Contextual complexity.” We design very simple experiment to distinguish the forms of complexity. We document behaviors in the context of Correlation Neglect (Enke and Zimmermann, 2019), a construct frequently used in experiments to assess the problem’s complexity relative to the ability to identify and understand correlations. Based on the results of lab experiments, we suggest examining the different attributes of complexity across different experimental designs.

“Flex or Commit? Randomization Revealed by Menu Choice”

Abstract Individuals may not be certain about their own preferences, leading to a preference for a flexible menu. At the same time, when an option combined with recommendations is tempting, people often prefer to commit to the smaller menu. Focusing on the condition in which these two forces occur simultaneously, I conduct an experiment to document the correlation between an individual’s ex-ante menu preference and the ex-post random choice. More specifically, the experiment tests the extent to which ex-post randomized choices are driven by a preference for flexibility or for commitment. From the experiment, we also verify whether the two driving forces can coexist and be reflected together in the ex-post choice.

PRE-DOCTORAL EXPERIENCES

Research Assistant for Young-Chul Kim (Sogang U.), Glenn Loury (Brown U.)

2019-2020

- On “Social Network Externalities and the Dynamics of Group Inequality.” Working with KLIPS (Korean Labor and Income Panel Study) data, tested lasting regional inequality in Korea with wage gaps

CONFERENCE/WORKSHOP PRESENTATIONS

2026

ESA North America Meeting 2026 at Virginia U (Scheduled), BEEMA10 at Penn State U, EEA-ESEM (Econometric Society European Meeting) 2026, M-BEES 2026 in Maastricht, EER Summer School 2026 at ISEG Lisbon, Midwest Theory Conference 2026

2025

BEEMA9 at Lehigh U, Midwest Experimental Economics Meeting for Graduate Students (MEEM-GS) at Indiana U, ESA North America Meeting 2025 at Tucson

2024

ESA North America Meeting at Ohio State U

2023

ESA North America Meeting at UNC Charlotte

2021

European Association of Environmental and Resource Economics (EAERE) 26th Annual Conference,
WEAI Virtual 96th Annual Conference, ESA North America Meeting at Tucson

AWARDS AND GRANTS

OHIO STATE U.

Larry and Shelia Kantor Award and Prize 2026

JMCB Grant for Graduate Student Research (\$4,500) 2025
- With Hyeonggyun Ko and Jason Tayawa

Decision Science Collaborative Research Grant (\$3,000) 2025

Department of Economics Fellowships 2021-22

SOGANG U.

Award for Devotion, Center for Teaching and Learning 2020
- Recognizing the service for the education of the school community after COVID-19 outbreak

Dean's List Award, Department of Economics 2018S, 2015S

Sogang Research Grant for Undergraduate Students 2017

Mirae Asset Study Abroad Scholarships (7,000,000 KRW) 2016

Academic Excellence Scholarships for Freshmen 2014-2015

TEACHING EXPERIENCES

Independent Instructor,

Principles of Microeconomics, 2026SU, 2025SU

Recitation Leader,

Microeconomics 1A (PhD-level course), 2025F, 2024F, 2023F
Principles of Microeconomics, 2024S, 2023S

Grader,

Intermediate Microeconomics, Principles of Microeconomics, Economic Issues in US 2026F, 2026S,
2022F, 2022S

Teaching Assistant for Prof. Yong Sakong, Sogang University 2019-2020
- Economic Statistics; Agricultural Economics; Markets for Derivatives

Head Tutor, Economics Study Center, Sogang University 2019-2020

SERVICES

'Graduate Women in Economics,' Ohio State University 2024-2026
President (2024-25), *Vice President* (2025-26)
Organizer, 'GWE Annual Research & Networking Forum' (2024-25)
(Advisor: Prof. Meta Brown)

PROGRAMMING SKILLS

- Mathematica, MATLAB, / - STATA, SAS, EViews, / - z-Tree, o-Tree / - $\text{\LaTeX}$

LANGUAGES

- English (Fluent), Korean (Native)

CITIZENSHIP

South Korea (F-1 Visa)

REFERENCES

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